towards Finland which, he says, was not based on legalistic–moralistic foundations but backed by massive military aid on the face of Soviet aggression that might have backfired on Britain's survival only. It would have faced destruction in the hands of Nazi Germany and would not have been able to restore the independence of Finland thus endangering its vital national interest, i.e., national survival. Morgenthau remarks asking: When the national interest related to national survival has been safeguarded, can nations pursue lesser interests?

4. Universal moral principles cannot be applied to state action. They must be filtered through concrete circumstances of time and place. To confuse individual morality with state morality is to court disaster, as states in pursuit of their national interest are governed by a morality that is different from the morality of individuals in their personal relationships.
5. Political realism refuses to identify the moral aspirations of a particular nation with the moral laws that govern the universe. It is the concept of interest defined in terms of power that saves us from the moral excess and political folly.
6. The political realist maintains the autonomy of the political sphere in the same way as the economist, the lawyer and the moralist do.[12] A political realist thinks in terms of interest defined in terms of power as the economist thinks in terms of interest defined as wealth, the lawyer in terms of the conformity of action with legal rules, and the moralist, who thinks in terms of the conformity of action with moral principles. Thus intellectually, political realist maintains the autonomy of the political sphere but never-the-less the political realist disregard the existence and importance of standards of thought other than political ones. It implies that each standard of thought should be assigned its proper sphere and function. The development of standards of thoughts in the field of politics, as in case of economics and other disciplines, is the main purpose of political realism.

Therefore, this Hobbesian, Machiavellian and Kautilyan understanding of human nature, as selfish and conflictual unless given appropriate conditions, has been succesfully adopted,